How Much of How Dad Manages Is on Paper?

Twelve quick questions about what you know. At the end: what you could write down today, what you're not sure of, and whom to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how much of the picture your family could put on paper today. It doesn't measure Dad, and no answer here says anything about how he's doing or what help he might want.

1. Have you heard, in Dad's own words, what he feels he does easily and where a hand is welcome?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Could you describe an ordinary week for Dad right now, more or less day by day?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know which everyday activities he does entirely on his own: bathing, dressing, eating, using the bathroom, getting around?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know what relatives, friends and neighbors do for him in an ordinary week, and roughly when each thing started?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know how he gets around, at home and out, and whether he uses anything to stand up, sit down or steady himself?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Have you written down what the family has noticed changing over time, as specific things that happened?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you have, in writing, what his clinicians have told him about his health and his care?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Is there a current list of everything he takes, and do you know where it's kept?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Have you written down your questions about his medications or therapies for the people who prescribe or provide them?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Does each thing you've written down have a date, and a note of who it came from?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Do you know which professional each of your open questions belongs with?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Have you asked his doctor which changes they'd want to hear about, and when they'd like to look again?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU COULD WRITE DOWN TODAY

WHAT YOU'RE NOT SURE OF

STILL BLANK, AND WHOM TO ASK

What this doesn't do

It counts what the family could write down today, not how Dad is managing. A low count only means there are blanks, and most of them fill in with a conversation with Dad or a few ordinary weeks of noticing.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of Dad's baseline are on paper and which are still blank. The care interview goes through those blanks with you, area by area, so keep the page you just copied beside you. Your answers become a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›